Adjectives & adverbs

QUICK REFERENCE | Suggested grades 2-5 | English

Use describing words to make a sentence more precise.

Adjectives describe nouns or pronouns

Ask: What kind? Which one? How many?

The small penguin found three smooth stones.

Small describes penguin. Three and smooth describe stones.

Adverbs describe verbs, adjectives, or other adverbs

Ask: How? When? Where? To what extent?

The penguin waddles slowly. Slowly tells how it waddles.

The water is very cold. Very describes the adjective cold.

Compare carefully

One	Compare two	Compare three or more
small	smaller	smallest
careful	more careful	most careful
good	better	best

Do not rely only on -ly

Quickly is an adverb, but friendly is usually an adjective.

Fast can be either: a fast runner (adjective); runs fast (adverb).

Quick check

Ask which word is being described. Then choose the word that fits.